SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #11 · HOLY SPIRIT

“If I don’t speak in tongues, I don’t have the Holy Spirit.”

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Where it often comes from

A church where speaking in tongues was treated as the main proof of being a real believer. Feeling left out or judged when others prayed in tongues and you did not. Pressure to produce an experience you never had. Comparing your quiet faith with other people’s more expressive worship. Christians differ on the place of tongues today, but Scripture is clear on the main question: every believer has the Spirit.

What Scripture teaches

Every person who belongs to Christ has the Holy Spirit. Believers are sealed with the Spirit when they hear and believe the gospel. Paul asks, “Do all speak in tongues?” and the expected answer is no. The Spirit gives different gifts to different people, as He chooses. The clearest evidence of His presence is not one gift, but His fruit: love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control.

> *“And in Him, having heard and believed the word of truth—the gospel of your salvation—you were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit, who is the pledge of our inheritance until the redemption of those who are God’s possession, to the praise of His glory”* **(Ephesians 1:13–14)**.

Also see

> “You, however, are controlled not by the flesh, but by the Spirit, if the Spirit of God lives in you. And if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to Christ” **(Romans 8:9)**.

> “For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, slave or free, and we were all given one Spirit to drink” **(1 Corinthians 12:13)**.

> “Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Do all work miracles? Do all have gifts of healing? Do all speak in tongues? Do all interpret? But eagerly desire the greater gifts. And now I will show you the most excellent way” **(1 Corinthians 12:29–31)**.

> “But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law” **(Galatians 5:22–23)**.

Common self-statements

- I must not really be saved.
- Something is wrong with me spiritually.
- God gave the Spirit to everyone but me.
- I’m a second-class Christian.
- If I had more faith, I would speak in tongues.
- Others are closer to God than I am.

Common logical errors

- **Overgeneralization:** Turning one gift that some receive into a test everyone must pass.

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you either have this gift or have no Spirit at all.
- **Comparison:** Measuring your walk with God by someone else's experience.
- **Disqualifying the positive:** Ignoring the fruit of the Spirit already growing in your life.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding "I feel left out, so God must have left me out."

Challenging questions

- What does Romans 8:9 say about everyone who belongs to Christ?
- When Paul asks, "Do all speak in tongues?" what answer does he expect?
- Who decides which gifts each believer receives?
- What fruit of the Spirit can I see growing in my life?
- Is this test coming from Scripture or from one group's experience?
- Did I believe in Christ? Then what does Ephesians 1:13 say happened?
- Can I respect believers who speak in tongues without doubting my own salvation?

Truth summary

> If I belong to Christ, I have the Holy Spirit. I was sealed with the Spirit when I believed the gospel. The Spirit gives different gifts to different people as He chooses, and no single gift is the test of His presence. I can look for His fruit in my life and use the gifts He has given me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Holy Spirit
- Gifts, Spiritual
- Holy Spirit, Pentecost
- Salvation
- Fruitful

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I don't speak in tongues, I don't have the Holy Spirit"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I don't speak in tongues, I don't have the Holy Spirit." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does Romans 8:9 say about all who belong to Christ?
- ☐ Does Paul expect all believers to speak in tongues?
- ☐ Who decides which gifts I receive?
- ☐ What fruit of the Spirit is growing in me?
- ☐ Is this test from Scripture or from one group?
- ☐ What happened when I believed the gospel?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ If I belong to Christ, I have the Holy Spirit.
- ☐ I was sealed with the Spirit when I believed.
- ☐ The Spirit gives gifts as He chooses.
- ☐ His fruit in my life shows His presence.
- ☐ I am not a second-class Christian.
- ☐ I can honor others' gifts and trust my own.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Ephesians 1:13–14**
  "And in Him, having heard and believed the word of truth—the gospel of your salvation—you were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit, who is the pledge of our inheritance until the redemption of those who are God's possession, to the praise of His glory."

- [ ] **Romans 8:9**
  "You, however, are controlled not by the flesh, but by the Spirit, if the Spirit of God lives in you. And if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to Christ."

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 12:13**
  "For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, slave or free, and we were all given one Spirit to drink."

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 12:29–31**
  "Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Do all work miracles? Do all have gifts of healing? Do all speak in tongues? Do all interpret? But eagerly desire the greater gifts. And now I will show you the most excellent way."

- [ ] **Galatians 5:22–23**
  "But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Fruit log:** Each day, write one way I saw love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, or self-control in my life.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Ephesians 1:13 becomes: "And in Him, having heard and believed the word of truth—the gospel of **her** salvation—**Sarah** was sealed with the promised Holy Spirit."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Holy Spirit" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio download.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 12 straight through,** and write down every gift Paul lists and who decides who gets them.
- ☐ **Ask two people who know you well:** "Where have you seen God's Spirit at work in me?" Write down their answers.
- ☐ **Use one gift you do have this week,** such as encouragement, serving, or giving, and notice how God uses it.
- ☐ **Talk with your pastor** about what your church believes about tongues and assurance.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I don't speak in tongues, I don't have the Holy Spirit": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One fruit of the Spirit I noticed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I don't speak in tongues, I don't have the Holy Spirit.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Holy Spirit, thank You that You live in everyone who belongs to Christ, including me. Help me reject the lie that I do not have You because I lack one gift. Grow Your fruit in my life, show me the gifts You have given me, and help me use them to serve others. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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